



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

asau munir niścaya+varma bibhrat |
sattva+āyudham* buddhi+śaraṁ* vikṛṣya |
jigīṣur* āste viṣayān madīyān |
tasmād* ayaṁ* me manaso* viṣādaḥ || 13.4 |*

— Buddhacarita, Chapter 13, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The verse paints a vivid picture of the internal battle we all face, as seen through the eyes of Mara, the embodiment of worldly temptations and distractions. Mara observes Siddhartha, now the ascetic aiming for enlightenment, and expresses his distress. He sees Siddhartha as a formidable warrior, resolute in his purpose, wearing determination as armor. Mara recognizes that Siddhartha is armed not with physical weapons, but with the power of inner strength ("sattva") as his weapon and wisdom ("buddhi") as his arrow. He is determined to conquer Mara's realm – the realm of desires, attachments, and illusions that keep us bound to suffering.

Mara laments that this ascetic seeks to overcome his domain, the very senses and worldly objects that he, Mara, holds sway over. "These are my domains," he proclaims, referring to the allurements that keep beings trapped in the cycle of rebirth. The verse highlights the source of Mara's despair: the understanding that Siddhartha's spiritual quest directly threatens his power. It is this threat that brings sadness to his heart.

In our own lives, we are constantly bombarded with temptations, distractions, and fleeting desires that pull us away from our true selves and our spiritual goals. Like Siddhartha, we must cultivate inner strength and wisdom to resist these distractions and stay focused on our path. We must recognize the "Mara" within ourselves – the part that clings to comfort, avoids discomfort, and seeks validation from external sources. By developing mindfulness and cultivating inner peace, we can diminish the power of this inner Mara and create space for growth and liberation. Just as Siddhartha threatened Mara's domain, your commitment to self-awareness threatens the grip of your own limiting beliefs and unhealthy patterns.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What "weapons" of inner strength and wisdom can you cultivate today to face the "Maras" that distract you from your spiritual path?